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The Verdict: How the NNP Lost Grenada, How the NDC Won It, and the Road Back for 2030/31

Fifteen constituencies, 282 polling divisions and one conclusion. The NNP did not lose 14 seats on polling day. It lost them over four years, through decisions it made itself. The NDC executed a plan. The way back is narrower than it looks, and shorter than it feels: 1,765 voters in seven seats.

BY GREG HOSTEN

GRENADA, CARRIACOU AND PETITE MARTINIQUE, GRENADA

ST. GEORGE'S, GRENADA—For fifteen weeks this journal has gone through Grenada's 2026 general election one constituency at a time, from the three-vote split in the Town of St. George to the hurricane-battered polling stations of Carriacou and Petite Martinique. This final volume puts the fifteen together.

"The NNP did not lose 14 seats on polling day. It lost them over four years, through decisions it made itself."

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The picture is not of a party swept away by a wave it could not have seen coming. It is of a party that made a series of choices between 2022 and 2026, about its leadership, its members, its candidates and its organisation, and lost seat after seat because of them. On the other side was a governing party that chose its moment, kept its candidates in place and worked its constituencies. The numbers show both clearly. They also show that the road back to government in 2030/31 is open, if the NNP starts on it now.

PART ONE: THE SCALE OF THE DEFEAT

On 5 November 2026 the NDC won 14 of the 15 seats with 37,369 votes. The NNP won one seat with 22,567 votes. All other parties and independents together took 1,328. Measured as a share of the vote for the two main parties, the NNP fell from 48.0 per cent in 2022 to 37.7 per cent, a swing of 10.3 points. It was the worst result in the party's history.

The raw votes are more telling still. The NNP lost 6,392 votes compared with 2022. The NDC gained 5,939. Over the same four years the register grew by 10,374 names, but only 607 more ballots were cast. Turnout fell from 70.2 per cent to 63.3 per cent.

Measured against the whole electorate, the NDC's share rose from 36.3 per cent of all registered voters to 38.5 per cent. The NNP's fell from 33.4 per cent to 23.3 per cent. The NDC did not sweep the country by converting millions. It held its voters, added some new ones, and watched the NNP's support drain away, much of it into staying at home.

The polling-division results make the depth of the defeat concrete. Of the 282 polling divisions published by the Parliamentary Elections Office, the NNP carried 38. Fourteen of those were in St. George North West, the one seat it held. In the other fourteen constituencies it won 24 divisions out of 267. In six constituencies, St. George South, St. George North East, St. George South East, St. David, St. Patrick West and the Town of St. George, it did not win a single division.

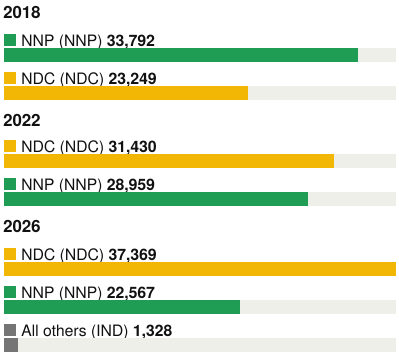
EVERY SEAT MOVED THE SAME WAY

The NNP's share of the two-party vote fell in all fifteen constituencies. The smallest fall was in St. George North West, 2.4 points, where Dr. Keith Mitchell handed over to Dr. Adrian Joseph. The largest, 24.6 points, was in the Town of St. George, where Peter David's breakaway took 730 votes. Between those extremes, the pattern is consistent enough to read as evidence.

Where the NNP ran a candidate the voters already knew, the fall was smaller than the national swing: 5.4 points in St. Andrew South East, 6.3 in St. John, 8.0 in St. Andrew North East. Where it ran a new candidate or one named late, the fall was at the national swing or worse: 9.0 in St. Andrew South West, 9.6 in St. David, 10.2 in St. Patrick East, 10.8 in Carriacou and Petite Martinique, 11.3 in St. George South

2018 VS 2022 VS 2026

Votes by candidate, in party colours



14–1

Seats, NDC to NNP, in 2026

BY THE NUMBERS

1 of 15

Seats won by the NNP, its worst result ever

–6,392

NNP votes lost since 2022, while ballots rose by 607

38 of 282

Polling divisions won by the NNP, 14 of them in one seat

1,765

Switchers needed in seven seats to reach a majority of eight

East, 13.2 in St. Patrick West, 13.9 in St. George South and 14.3 in St. Mark. Where it lost its own sitting member to the other side, as in St. Andrew North West, it fell 12.4.

In other words, the NNP's local decisions decided how badly each seat went. The national mood set the direction. The party's own choices set the size.

PART TWO: THE TEN FAILURES OF THE NNP

What follows is not a list of misfortunes. Each failure was a decision, or the absence of one, and each is visible in the results.

1. A LEADERSHIP TRANSITION LEFT TOO LATE AND HANDLED BADLY

The NNP's convention to choose a successor to Dr. Mitchell was held on 15 December 2024, about two years overdue. The contest was between Emmalin Pierre and Peter David. Mr. David withdrew hours before the vote, alleging that the process was rigged, and resigned from the party the following month. The New Today's editorial judgement was that Dr. Mitchell had badly handled the transition.

A leadership change two years before an election is already late. A contested one that ends with the losing candidate leaving the party is worse. It cost the NNP a sitting MP, a branch executive in the capital, and in the end the Town of St. George itself, lost by three votes to the split.

2. TWO OF SIX ELECTED MEMBERS LOST BEFORE POLLING DAY

The NNP won six seats in 2022. Within three years it had lost two of the members who won them. Delma Thomas resigned in May 2023, saying her attempts to represent St. Andrew North West from inside the party had been frustrated, and joined the NDC government. Mr. David left in January 2025.

Both seats were lost in 2026. Ms. Thomas won St. Andrew North West for the NDC by 785. Mr. David's new party split the vote in the Town. A party that cannot keep its own elected members cannot keep their seats, and the NNP lost a third of its parliamentary group to departures alone.

3. CARETAKERS NAMED LATE

In the seats lost in 2022, the NNP waited almost three years to name new caretakers. Four were presented on 23 April 2025: for St. David, St. George South, St. Patrick West and St. Andrew South West, about 19 months before polling day. Norland Cox was named for Carriacou and Petite Martinique in September 2025, about 14 months before.

Every one of those five seats fell by at least 9 points, and three of them by more than the national swing. Nineteen months is not long enough to become known in a constituency of 5,000 to 12,000 voters, especially against a sitting minister.

4. CARETAKERS WITHOUT THE MEANS TO CAMPAIGN

In 2025 The New Today reported speculation that several of the new caretakers, including in St. George South, were working without party offices. A former NNP minister said in the same report that only sitting NNP MPs had constituency offices, funded by the state, and accused the party leadership of not doing enough to help the newcomers financially.

In February 2026 the NNP announced that it was the first party to name a full slate of 15 candidates. A full slate is a press release. An office, staff, a household list and a budget are a campaign. In too many seats the NNP had the first and not the second.

5. CANDIDATE CHURN AND PARACHUTING

In St. George South, the country's largest seat, the NNP ran four different candidates in four elections. Its 2022 candidate there, Mr. Cox, was moved to Carriacou for 2026 and lost both seats. Voters notice when a candidate is posted rather than rooted.

The NDC did the opposite. David Andrew lost St. Andrew South East in 2022, stayed, and won it in 2026. Ron Redhead, Kerryne James and Lennox Andrews all defended seats they had won four years earlier, and all increased their majorities.

6. SUCCESSION LEFT TO CHANCE

The single best NNP result of 2026 came from the one seat where succession was planned. Dr. Mitchell announced his retirement on 22 January 2026 and named Dr. Joseph the same night, ten months before polling day. The NNP's share in St. George North West fell by only 2.4 points.

Where long-serving members left without that kind of public handover, the results were far worse. In St. Mark the NNP's share fell 14.3 points after Clarice Modeste-Curwen left the ballot. In St. George South East, without Gregory Bowen, it fell 11.3. The lesson is not complicated. The party simply did not apply it.

7. THE LEADER IN A MARGINAL SEAT

Ms. Pierre's majority in St. Andrew South East had fallen from 1,158 in 2018 to 233 in 2022. The party then made her its leader, its Leader of the Opposition and its national campaigner. In 2026 her own vote fell by only 44, but the NDC found 351 more, and she lost by 162.

A party leader in a marginal seat needs a full-time local campaign behind her, so that she can travel. There is no public sign that St. Andrew South East had one.

8. THE NNP'S OWN VOTERS STAYED HOME

The biggest single failure is in the turnout figures. Across the country the NNP lost 6,392 votes, while the total number of ballots rose by 607. In seat after seat the NDC's share of the electorate held steady and the NNP's fell. In St. Andrew North East, the register grew by 647 and ballots by six, and the NNP lost 339 votes, more than the 320 by which it lost the seat. In St. George North East and St. George South, turnout fell by almost ten points.

These are not voters who were persuaded by the NDC. They are voters the NNP did not reach. They are also the cheapest votes to win back.

9. A MESSAGE THAT DID NOT LAND

The NNP's campaign asked whether voters were better off four years on, and offered specific measures such as removing VAT on sugar within 90 days. Neither cut through. The election was called almost a year early, leaving the opposition little more than a month of formal campaign, and a party that has not been in constant contact with voters cannot introduce a programme in five weeks.

After the result the political scientist Peter Wickham said Ms. Pierre should consider stepping down to allow the party to refresh itself. Whatever one makes of that, the campaign's central argument plainly failed to move the voters who had backed the NNP in 2022.

10. THE CAPITAL LOST TO A SPLIT

The Town of St. George is the clearest example of a self-inflicted defeat. The NDC won it with 1,269 votes. The NNP and Mr. David's DPM together had 1,266. Three votes. The split began at the NNP's own convention.

Nowhere else did the DPM decide a seat. But in the capital it did, and the NNP's own internal politics created it.

PART THREE: HOW THE NDC EXECUTED

A fair verdict must also credit the winner. The NDC did not win 14 seats by accident, and an opposition that does not understand how it was beaten will be beaten again.

IT CHOSE THE BATTLEFIELD AND THE DATE

Prime Minister Dickon Mitchell advised dissolution on 2 October 2026, nominations were set for 15 October and polling for 5 November, almost a year before the constitutional deadline. A governing party with a record to run on and an opposition still organising is best served by a short campaign. That is what the NDC chose.

IT KEPT ITS CANDIDATES AND WORKED ITS SEATS

Every NDC member elected in 2022 who stood again in 2026 increased their majority. Andy Williams went from 1,068 to 2,792 in St. George South. Ron Redhead from 1,087 to 2,027 in St. George North East. Phillip Telesford from 488 to 1,294 in St. George South East. Kerryne James from 7 to 573 in St. John. Lennox Andrews from 425 to 1,094 in St. Andrew South West. Joseph Andall from 268 to 1,160 in St. Patrick West. Tevin Andrews from 149 to 976 in Carriacou. The Prime Minister himself from 1,672 to 3,180 in St. David.

In most of those seats the NDC's share of the whole electorate held steady or rose. Its members were present between elections, and the voters rewarded them.

IT GAVE ITS PEOPLE VISIBLE ROLES

The NDC used government to raise the profile of its members in their own seats. Mr. Williams served repeatedly as Acting Prime Minister. Mr. Andall became Foreign Minister. Ms. James held the climate and environment portfolio. Mr. Andrew, after losing in 2022, became Minister of Education and came back to win. Each appointment made the local member a national figure in the eyes of their own constituents.

IT WELCOMED DEFECTORS AND TARGETED NNP SEATS

When Ms. Thomas left the NNP in 2023, the NDC brought her into government, and she held St. Andrew North West in its colours. The party then went after the NNP's remaining seats. The Prime Minister singled out St. Mark when he announced the election. Of the six seats the NNP held in 2022, the NDC took five: St. Andrew South East, St. Andrew North East, St. Andrew North West, St. Mark and the Town of St. George.

IT GOVERNED THROUGH A DISASTER AND WAS CREDITED FOR IT

Hurricane Beryl devastated Carriacou and Petite Martinique in July 2024. The government controlled the recovery, and the NDC's member there, the party's chairman, was its local face. His majority rose from 149 to 976. Incumbency in a crisis is a powerful advantage, and the NDC used it.

None of this is a secret method. It is what disciplined parties do: pick candidates early, keep them in place, give them visible work, and turn up between elections. The NNP did all of these things in its years of dominance. It can do them again.

PART FOUR: THE ARITHMETIC OF 2030/31

Government requires eight seats. The NNP holds one. On a uniform national swing it would need to recover about 12.8 points of the two-party vote, to roughly 50.5 per cent nationally, to reach eight. That sounds daunting. But elections are not won on uniform swings. They are won seat by seat.

Rank the fourteen lost seats by the number of voters who would have had to switch sides for the NNP to win in 2026. Seven of them are within reach: St. Andrew South East needed 82 switchers, St. Mark 131, St. Andrew North East 161, St. John 287, St. Patrick East 344, the Town of St. George 367 against the NDC alone, and St. Andrew North West 393. Together, that is 1,765 voters, under 3 per cent of the 61,460 ballots cast in 2026. Hold St. George North West, win those seven, and the NNP has eight.

In the Town of St. George the arithmetic is even closer than it looks. The NNP and the DPM together had 1,266 votes to the NDC's 1,269. A reunited opposition there starts three votes behind.

Behind that first tier sit Carriacou and Petite Martinique (489 switchers), St. Andrew South West (548), St. Patrick West (581) and St. George South East (648). These are the seats that turn a narrow majority into a working one. The third tier, St. George North East (1,014), St. George South (1,397) and St. David (1,591), is a two-election project.

PART FIVE: WHAT THE NNP MUST DO TO STAND A CHANCE

What follows is a plan, not a wish list. Every item is measurable, and every item answers one of the failures above.

SETTLE THE LEADERSHIP PROPERLY, AND EARLY

The party's leadership must be settled, by an open, fair and transparent process that every faction accepts, by the end of 2027 at the latest. Whether the outcome is Ms. Pierre or another leader matters less than that the process is clean and the result is final. The 2024 convention, two years late and ending in a walkout, must not be repeated. Whoever leads should not also be defending a marginal seat without a full-time deputy and organiser at home.

BRING THE FAMILY BACK TOGETHER

The NNP lost two members to departures and the capital to a split. Reconciliation, with former members and with those who left with them, is not sentiment. It is arithmetic. In the Town alone, it is worth three votes from victory. The party should open formal talks with former members and the DPM's supporters in 2027, and create a clear route back for any who wish to return.

NAME EVERY CANDIDATE BY THE END OF 2027, AND KEEP THEM

Adopt a party rule: every constituency has a confirmed candidate within 18 months of an election, and that candidate is committed to two elections unless they choose to step aside. Candidates should live in, or have deep roots in, the seat they contest. No more moving candidates between constituencies. No more four candidates in four elections.

FUND THE FIELD, CENTRALLY

Every Tier 1 seat needs a permanent office, a paid organiser and a monthly budget from 2028, funded centrally by the party rather than left to the candidate. Tier 2 seats should follow in 2029. The cost is modest compared with what was lost, and it answers directly the complaint that caretakers were left without offices in 2025.

BUILD A VOTER FILE AND A CAPTAIN IN EVERY DIVISION

The NNP needs a household-level voter file for all 282 polling divisions, starting from its 2022 vote, when 28,959 people voted for the party. Recruit a captain for

every division, with targets for contacts each quarter, and publish progress to members every six months. Contact every known 2022 supporter at least three times a year. Those 6,392 lost voters are the cheapest votes the party will ever win back.

REGISTER THE NEW VOTERS

The register grew by 10,374 names between 2022 and 2026, and the NNP found few of them. Run a permanent registration drive aimed at young people, returning nationals and new residents, with a monthly target in every constituency. In St. David alone the register grew by 1,444, and in St. George South by 1,200.

PLAN EVERY SUCCESSION IN PUBLIC

Every NNP constituency with a long-serving member should have a named successor, announced publicly with the member's support, at least two years before the election. St. George North West proved the method works. St. Mark and St. George South East proved what happens without it.

EARN A MESSAGE IN THE CONSTITUENCIES FIRST

A national programme cannot be introduced in five weeks. Run listening programmes in every Tier 1 and Tier 2 seat from 2028, by sector as well as by village: hotel and airport workers in the south, fishers in Gouyave and Soubise, farmers in St. Andrew and St. Patrick, students and staff at SGU and TAMCC, and the families rebuilding after Beryl. Build the 2030/31 manifesto from what people say, and publish it a full year before the election is due. Hold the government to account in public with quarterly constituency report cards measured against its own promises.

BE READY FOR AN EARLY ELECTION

The NDC called the 2026 election almost a year early. It may do so again. Every target seat must be ready for a five-week campaign from the beginning of 2029: candidate in place, office open, voter file current, captains trained, transport and polling-day plans written. A party that is ready early cannot be ambushed by the calendar.

A TIMELINE FOR THE NEXT FOUR YEARS

2027: settle the leadership; open reconciliation talks; adopt the candidate and succession rules; confirm candidates in all seven Tier 1 seats; begin the voter file from the 2022 vote.

2028: open funded offices in all Tier 1 seats; recruit captains for every Tier 1 division; begin listening programmes; start monthly registration drives; confirm candidates in all remaining seats.

2029: open offices in Tier 2 seats; complete captains in all 282 divisions; publish quarterly report cards on sitting members; be ready for an early election from January.

2030: publish the manifesto at least a year before the election is due; run turnout operations built on the voter file; measure every seat against its target number of switchers and supporters, and report it to members.

THE VERDICT

The NNP lost in 2026 because it spent four years on internal conflict, late decisions and thin organisation, while the NDC spent them working its seats. That is a hard verdict. It is also a hopeful one, because every one of those failures is within the party's own power to fix.

Seven seats. Fewer than 1,800 voters. Four years. The road back to government is narrower than the NNP's supporters would like, but it is far shorter than the result of 5 November makes it feel. The question is not whether it can be done. It is whether the party will start now.

ALL FIFTEEN SEATS: THE NNP'S SHARE OF THE TWO-PARTY VOTE

Constituency	2022	2026	Change	PDs won	Switchers needed
St. George North West	74.1%	71.7%	−2.4	14 of 15	held
St. Andrew South East	53.3%	47.9%	−5.4	7 of 16	82
St. Andrew North East	54.0%	46.0%	−8.0	5 of 15	161
St. Mark	59.6%	45.4%	−14.3	3 of 13	131
St. John	49.9%	43.6%	−6.3	4 of 21	287
St. Andrew North West	51.8%	39.4%	−12.4	1 of 16	393
St. Patrick East	47.8%	37.6%	−10.2	2 of 14	344
Carriacou and Petite Martinique	48.0%	37.2%	−10.8	1 of 18	489
St. Andrew South West	44.5%	35.5%	−9.0	1 of 20	548
St. Patrick West	45.8%	32.6%	−13.2	0 of 16	581
St. George South East	43.5%	32.2%	−11.3	0 of 20	648
St. George North East	39.8%	30.2%	−9.6	0 of 23	1,014
Town of St. George	54.3%	29.7%	−24.6	0 of 12	367*
St. David	38.3%	28.7%	−9.6	0 of 30	1,591
St. George South	42.4%	28.5%	−13.9	0 of 33	1,397

Two-party share = NNP ÷ (NNP + NDC). *Town: against the NDC alone; NNP and DPM combined were 3 votes short. PDs: polling divisions as published by the Parliamentary Elections Office. 2026 figures provisional.

THE PATH TO EIGHT SEATS

Tier		Seats	Switchers needed	Target date
Hold	St. George North West		—	2027 onward
Tier 1	St. Andrew South East, St. Mark, St. Andrew North East, St. John, St. Patrick East, Town of St. George, St. Andrew North West		1,765 in total	Candidates by end 2027; offices 2028
Tier 2	Carriacou and Petite Martinique, St. Andrew South West, St. Patrick West, St. George South East		2,266 in total	Candidates 2028; offices 2029
Tier 3	St. George North East, St. George South, St. David		4,002 in total	Two-election project

Switchers needed: the number of 2026 NDC voters who would have had to vote NNP instead for the NNP to win, given the 2026 result. Hold St. George North West plus all of Tier 1 = 8 seats.

THE NATIONAL ARITHMETIC

Measure	2022	2026	Change
NNP votes	28,959	22,567	−6,392
NDC votes	31,430	37,369	+5,939
NNP share of two-party vote	48.0%	37.7%	−10.3 pts
Seats (NDC–NNP)	9–6	14–1	
Registered voters	86,657	97,031	+10,374
Ballots cast	60,853	61,460	+607
Turnout	70.2%	63.3%	−6.9 pts
NNP votes as a share of all registered voters	33.4%	23.3%	−10.1 pts
NDC votes as a share of all registered voters	36.3%	38.5%	+2.2 pts
Polling divisions won by the NNP		38 of 282	
Switchers needed for eight seats		1,765	

2022: sum of constituency results (Wikipedia). 2026: Parliamentary Elections Office provisional results, read 9 Nov 2026. Registered voters and ballots are summed from constituency figures.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR 2030/31

1. Settle the leadership openly, cleanly and by the end of 2027.
2. Keep elected members inside the party: two of six walked and both seats fell.
3. Reunite the opposition: in the Town it is three votes from victory.
4. Name every candidate by the end of 2027, and keep them for two elections.
5. No parachuting, and no four candidates in four elections.
6. Fund offices and organisers centrally, Tier 1 first.
7. Build a voter file and a captain in all 282 divisions.
8. Win back the 6,392 NNP voters of 2022 before chasing anyone else.
9. Plan every succession in public, as in St. George North West.
10. Be ready for an early election from January 2029.

Sources: Parliamentary Elections Office live results, live.elections.gd (2026, provisional; all constituencies and polling divisions read 7 and 9 Nov 2026); Wikipedia (2018, 2022 and 2026 general elections; New National Party); NOW Grenada (NNP convention, 15 Dec 2024; Peter David resignation, 21 Jan 2025; Delma Thomas resignation, May 2023; NNP caretakers, 23 Apr and 16 Sep 2025; 'One seat, many questions', 6 Nov 2026; 2026 results); The New Today (editorials on the NNP transition; NNP caretakers report, 2025); Caribbean National Weekly (election date; NNP convention, Jun 2026); Jamaica Gleaner / CMC (election announcement, Oct 2026; results, 6 Nov 2026); Jamaica Observer / CMC (Mitchell retirement, 23 Jan 2026); The Watchers / ReliefWeb (Hurricane Beryl, Jul 2024). Analytics computed by the author from the published counts. Vols. 1–15 of this series give the full sources for each constituency. Analysis by Greg Hosten, Vol. 16 of a weekly constituency series. Written in the style of a newspaper report; not a publication of any news organisation.